MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PEPPERS, GREEN AND RED, DEHYDRATED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers dehydrated red and green sweet bell peppers for use by the Armed Forces as an item of general issue.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Types

I - Green

II - Red

III - Mixed red and green

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Natick Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRXNM-TDS, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8915

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495	-	Coating, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Non Perishable Subsistence
MIL-D-43266	-	Desiccants and Desiccation, Method of; for Packaging Subsistence

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-668	-	Sanitary Standards for Food Plants

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

NATIONAL RESEARCH COUNCIL

Food Chemicals Codex (F.C.C.)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Director, National Academy of Sciences, National Research Council, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

AMERICAN DRY MILK INSTITUTE, INC.

Standards for Grades of Dry Milks, Including Methods of Analysis, Bulletin 916

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dry Milk Institute, Inc., 130 North Franklin St., Chicago, IL 60606.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Type I. Type I peppers shall be properly matured, green, sweet bell peppers of similar varietal and dehydration characteristics. Peppers of the hot pungent varieties shall not be used. They shall possess a generally uniform typical green color with some variation from bright green to olive green and shall be firm and practically free from defects caused by hail, scars, sunburn, disease, insects, or mechanical or other means, except for small fresh holes or splits incident to proper handling. The sweet bell peppers shall have been properly washed to remove soil, spray residue, and foreign material. In addition, they shall have been sorted to remove diseased and seriously damaged units, cored and trimmed to remove seeds, seed cells, and rotted areas, and cut into approximately 1/4 by 1/4 inch (6 by 6 mm) square pieces with a minimum of tearing and rough cutting, in order to comply with 3.2.

* 3.1.2 Type II. Type II peppers shall conform to 3.1.1 except for color. They shall possess a generally uniform typical red color with some variation from bright red to orange red after being properly trimmed and washed.

* 3.1.3 Type III. Type III mixed red and green peppers shall conform to 3.1.1 except that they shall consist of sweet bell peppers, of which, by weight, not less than 35 percent are generally uniform typical green pieces and not less than 35 percent are generally uniform typical red pieces. Sweet bell peppers which are in the process of turning from green to red, including shades of brown, are permissible provided minimum percentages of strictly green and red pieces are present.

3.1.4 Sodium sulfite and sodium acid sulfite. The sulfite(s) used shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex and shall be used in such quantities as to meet the requirements of 3.2.1.

* 3.2 Finished product.

3.2.1 Dehydrated products (types I, II and III). The dehydrated sweet bell peppers shall be free from insect infestation, splinters, paint, varnish, rubber, metals or other foreign material and from haylike, scorched, rancid, musty, or other objectionable odors. The moisture content of the dehydrated sweet bell peppers, by weight, prior to packaging, shall not exceed 5.0 percent for type I, 7.5 percent for type II and 5.5 percent for type III. The sulfite content (calculated as sulfur dioxide) shall be not less than 1000 nor more than 2500 parts per million. Not more than 10 percent, by weight, of the product shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve, when examined as specified in 4.4.1.1 and there shall be not more than 25 seeds per 100 grams of dehydrated sweet bell peppers.

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3.2.2 Rehydrated products.

3.2.2.1 Rehydration. The sweet bell peppers shall rehydrate to approximately their original cut form when 1 avoirdupois ounce (28 g) of the dehydrated product (on a dry solids basis) is added to 16 fluid ounces (473 ml) of cold (45° ± 10°F) (7.2 ± 5.5°C) water and allowed to soak for 2 hours at ordinary refrigerated temperature (approximately 40°F (5°C)).

3.2.2.1.1 Color.

3.2.2.1.1.1 Type I. Not less than 95 percent, by weight, of the green sweet bell peppers shall possess a generally uniform typical green color with some variation from bright green to olive green.

3.2.2.1.1.2 Type II. Not less than 95 percent, by weight, of the red sweet bell peppers shall possess a generally uniform typical red color with some variation from bright red to orange red.

3.2.2.1.1.3 Type III. The mixed red and green sweet bell peppers shall consist of not less than 35 percent generally uniform typical green pieces and 35 percent generally uniform typical red pieces, by weight. The balance of the pieces may be in the process of turning from green to red and may include pieces of varying shades of brown provided the color is natural and is not due to scorching.

3.2.2.1.2 Defects. The sweet bell peppers shall be practically free from defects which means that there are no more than two percent, by weight, of defective pieces such as those affected by scorch, hail, sunburn, disease, rot, insect or mechanical damage, stem, core or placenta tissue.

3.2.2.1.3 Flavor and odor. The product shall possess a normal sweet bell pepper flavor and odor and shall be free from objectionable foreign flavors and odors.

3.2.2.1.4 Texture. The sweet bell pepper units shall be firm, full fleshed and tender.

3.3 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.4 Workmanship. The product shall be prepared, processed and packaged under modern sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsiblity for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection

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requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preacceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection). Product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.4.

4.3 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents.

4.3.1.1 Sulfite. Conformance of sulfite to 3.1.4 shall be ascertained by examination of label, invoice, or other valid document. Sulfite not conforming to Food Chemicals Codex shall be unacceptable and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved finished product.

4.3.1.2 Testing of cans. Testing of cans shall be as shown in table I. Test requirements for tin plate shall be an average requirement. A test failure shall indicate an unacceptable component and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of finished product.

TABLE I. Testing of cans

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristics	Results reported	Test ref & rqmt para
Can and lid 1/	One can and lid	Cans	S-1	Tin plate	Nearest 0.01 lb/ base box	4.4 & 5.1.1

1/ Testing of can coating (when required) and can labeling shall be performed on the same cans submitted for tin plate test with additional cans as required to complete the sample plan of TT-C-495.

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4.3.2 Process examination. Examination shall be performed during processing to determine compliance with requirements contained in 3.1.1 through 3.1.3 as concerns kind of peppers, and procedures pertinent to preparation of peppers prior to dehydration. Nonconformance to one or more requirement(s) shall be cause for rejection of the involved peppers.

4.3.3 Examination of end item. Examinations shall be in accordance with tables III through V and 4.3.3.1 through 4.3.3.3. The sampling plans for the aforementioned tables shall be in accordance with table II. The acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be expressed as defects per hundred units for table V and percent defective for tables III and IV.

TABLE II. Sampling plans

Table	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	AQLs	
				Major	Minor
III	One filled and closed can	Cans	S-3	0.65	--
IV	One filled can	Cans	S-3	--	2.5
V	One filled can	Cans	S-2	1.5	

TABLE III. Examination for leakage 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Leakage.

1/ See 4.4 for procedure.

TABLE IV. Examination for net weight 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	More than 5 percent under specified dry solids weight.

1/ Subtract weight of moisture (based on average moisture analysis as determined by moisture test specified in 4.4) from actual net weight.

2/ Report results to the nearest gram. Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicates a lot average weight less than specified weight.

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TABLE V. Examination of can contents 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
	Desiccant
101	Desiccant bag(s) missing.
102	Desiccant bag has tear, hole or open seam.
	Dehydrated product
103	More than 25 seeds per 100 grams.
104	More than 10 percent, by weight, passes through a U. S. Standard No. 8 sieve. 2/
	Rehydrated product 3/
105	Dehydrated product does not rehydrate to approximately its original cut form in 2 hours (see 3.2.2.1).
106	More than 5 percent, by weight, of type I sweet bell peppers do not possess a generally uniform typical green color with some variation from bright green to olive green.
107	More than 5 percent, by weight, of type II sweet bell peppers do not possess a generally uniform typical red color with some variation from bright red to orange red.
108	Type III sweet bell peppers possess less than 35 percent, by weight, of generally uniform typical green pieces or 35 percent, by weight, of generally uniform typical red pieces.
109	Sweet bell pepper pieces not firm, fully fleshed and tender.
110	More than two percent, by weight, of defective pieces.
111	Objectionable flavor or odor.

1/ Presence of foreign material (e.g. splinters, paint, varnish, rubber, metals, insect, insect fragments, wood, dirt, glass, rust, or other extraneous materials) shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot.

2/ Examination to be performed in accordance with 4.4.

3/ Make one determination per sample unit.

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4.3.3.1 Examination of cans. Examination of cans for external condition and labeling shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

4.3.3.2 Examination of shipping containers. The filled and closed shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the examination: Major - Markings missing, incomplete or illegible; Minor - Arrangement of cans not as specified. For level C pack, as specified in 5.2.3, only the defects applicable to marking and arrangement shall apply.

* 4.3.3.3 Examination of unit loads. Unit loads shall be examined in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078 and the applicable specification sheet for the type and class of load specified (see 5.3).

4.3.4 Testing of cans with type II or III product for oxygen content. Cans with type II or III product shall be tested for oxygen content. Test procedures shall be in accordance with 4.4. The sample unit for testing oxygen content shall be one filled and sealed can. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. Lot size shall be expressed in cans. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. The acceptable quality level, expressed as percent defective, shall be 1.5. A result of more than 2.0 percent shall be a defect.

4.3.5 Testing of finished product. The finished product shall be tested for moisture and sulfite content in accordance with 4.4. The sample for testing shall be an 8 ounce (227 g) composite derived from the number of cans indicated by inspection level S-2. Lot size shall be expressed in cans. Each sample can shall be selected during the packaging operation just prior to closure. The desiccant shall be removed from each sample can. Each sample can shall be appropriately marked for identification and then closed immediately. The composite shall be formed at the laboratory just prior to testing. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent for moisture and nearest ppm for sulfite. A test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4 Test methods. Examination and test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the contractor if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum such quality assurance, the contractor will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

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4.4.1 Examination procedures.

4.4.1.1 Screening. Screening examination shall be performed as follows: Weigh entire contents of can. Place approximately 2 ounces or 50 grams of dehydrated material on an 8-inch (203 mm) diameter (or approximately 4-1/2 ounces or 130 grams on a 12-inch (305 mm) diameter), U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve, tip back and forth through a 90-degree arc 25 times. Empty material remaining on sieve into an appropriate container and repeat this procedure until entire contents of can have been screened. Weigh total material passing through sieve and calculate percentage.

4.4.1.2 Leakage. The filled and sealed can shall be examined for leakage by submerging in water contained in a desiccator or other suitable container and maintaining a vacuum of 10 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) (a pressure of not more than 67.2 kPa) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered signs of leakage.

4.4.2 Test procedures.

4.4.2.1 Moisture. Moisture determination shall be made by the vacuum-oven method as specified in 4.4.2.1.1 and 4.4.2.1.2.

4.4.2.1.1 Preparation of sample. Sample shall be prepared as follows: Grind approximately 100 grams of a well mixed sample in a clean, dry Waring blender or similar mill for 1 minute.

4.4.2.1.2 Procedures. Weigh two approximately 2-gram samples of the ground material into tared, dry, aluminum weighing dishes (approximately 2 to 2-1/2 inches (51 to 64 mm) in diameter and 3/4-inch (19 mm) in depth) with tight-fitting covers. Place the dishes with cocked lids in a vacuum oven and dry for 16 hours at 60°C under a pressure of not more than 100 mm mercury (13.3 kPa). During drying, admit to the oven a slow current of air (approximately two bubbles per second), dried by passing through concentrated sulphuric acid. Remove the dishes and allow them to cool in a desiccator before weighing. Calculate the percent of moisture in the original sample.

* 4.4.2.2 Sulfite determination. Sulfite shall be determined as follows: Prepare sample as described in 4.4.2.1.1 and determine sulfite according to the method specified in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Food Additives; Direct, Section: Chemical Preservatives, Method: Total Sulfurous Acid, Modified Moner-Williams.

* 4.4.2.3 Test for oxygen content. Oxygen content shall be determined in accordance with the American Dry Milk Institute, Inc., publication, Bulletin 916, Standard for Grades of Dry Milks Including Methods of Analysis; Section; Methods of Analyses: Determination of Oxygen.

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4.4.2.4 Tin coating weight. Tin coating weights shall be determined by any method specified in PPP-C-96.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Preservation-packaging shall be in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

* 5.1.1 Level A. On a dry solids basis, 4.25 ounces (120 g) of the type I, 7.5 ounces (213 g) of the type II, or 5.4 ounces (153 g) of type III product, in accordance with 3.2, as applicable, shall be filled into a size 401 by 411, open-top style, round, metal can with soldered side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. The can shall be made throughout from not less than commercial 0.25-pound electrolytic tin plate per base box (see 4.4.2.4) and shall be coated outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495. Desiccant in accordance with MIL-D-43266 and in quantities capable of lowering the moisture content of the type I or type III product to 1.5 percent and of the type II product to 2.5 percent shall be included in each can. The type II and type III product shall be packaged under an atmosphere of nitrogen so that the oxygen content of the filled and sealed cans does not exceed 2.0 percent when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.3. The can shall be hermetically sealed. The filled and sealed cans shall not show leakage when examined in accordance with 4.4.1.2.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating shall be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. Twenty-four cans of the product, arranged 4 in length, 3 in width, and 2 in depth, shall be packed on end into a snug-fitting shipping container in accordance with levels A, B or C as specified (see 6.1). Style RSC boxes may be top-opening or end-opening (see 6.4).

5.2.1 Level A packing. The shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V2s of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B packing. The shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, W5c, or W5s of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 Nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

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5.2.3 Level C packing. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078, for the type and class of load specified.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the following information shall appear on the body or one end of the can:

PEPPERS, DEHYDRATED (in letters larger than any others used for the label)
(and as applicable)

Type I - Green

Type II - Red

Type III - Mixed Red and Green

GAS PACKED) (applicable to Types II and III)

PRESERVED WITH SULFUR DIOXIDE

----------oz. (gm) net (dry solids basis)

----------Name and address of packer

----------Location of processing plant (if different than above)

REMOVE AND DISCARD DESICCANT BAG

DIRECTIONS FOR USE

Cover 1 ounce (3/4 cup) dehydrated sweet peppers with 16 fluid ounces (1/2 quart) cool water. Soak 30 minutes if sweet bell peppers are to be used for cooking; soak at least 1 hour and preferably overnight in a refrigerator if they are to be used in a salad. Dehydrated sweet bell peppers may be added to soups and stews without presoaking.

NOTE: One ounce dehydrated sweet bell peppers equals 8 ounces of fresh sweet bell peppers, as purchased, or 6-1/2 ounces cut green sweet bell peppers or 5 ounces cut red sweet bell peppers, or 5-3/4 ounces cut mixed green and red sweet bell peppers, as applicable.

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5.4.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. In addition, on the side opposite the marked side, in letters between 1 and 1-1/2 inches (25 and 38 mm) high (all letters being of the same height), the following precautionary markings shall appear:

PRESERVED WITH SULFUR DIOXIDE

5.4.3 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type of product required (see 1.2).
(c) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1, 5.2 and 6.2).
(d) When packing specified in 5.2.2.1 is required (see 6.3).
(e) Type and class of unit load required when unit loading is specified (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.14D/DSAR 4145.7.

6.3 Intended use of nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. Packing specified in 5.2.2.1 is intended for transfer at sea operations and special overseas operations.

6.4 RSC end-opening shipping container. When style RSC boxes are end-opening, reinforcement and marking shall be in the same relationship to the contents as for top-opening boxes.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8915-0515

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

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MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

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☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

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